DIGITAL LITERACY

Project Report

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Project Introduction

As a newly selected Student Digital Ambassador, my role is to assist peers in navigating the digital landscape, focusing on professional online identity and safe communication. This project serves as a Digital Literacy Portfolio designed to demonstrate core competencies across five essential modules of the course.

The project is structured into the following five tasks:

- Task 1 (Digital Literacy Awareness): Development of a one-page visual infographic using tools like Canva or Prezi to explain digital literacy and safe internet practices.

- Task 2 (Digital Portfolio): Establishing a professional online presence by setting up foundational profiles on platforms such as LinkedIn and GitHub.

- Task 3 (Coding & Collaboration): Demonstrating technical and collaborative skills by completing a coding challenge on HackerRank and creating a digital literacy quiz via Google Forms.

- Task 4 (Email Etiquette): Drafting professional emails for academic and internship-related scenarios, alongside a social media "Do’s and Don’ts" guide.

- Task 5 (Cybercrime Awareness): Researching a case study on threats like Phishing or UPI fraud and creating a prevention checklist for student safety. All deliverables are organized within a dedicated GitHub repository, which includes the individual task folders, a README overview, and this final project report

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For the first task of my Digital Ambassador role, I designed a one-page visual infographic aimed at educating my peers on the essential pillars of digital literacy. I used Canva to create the resource because of its extensive library of professional templates and intuitive drag-and-drop interface, which allowed me to focus on content hierarchy rather than complex graphic design. My design specifically highlights three critical areas: a clear definition of digital literacy, a list of essential digital tools for B.Tech students (such as GitHub and LinkedIn), and a section dedicated to safe internet practices.

What I found most interesting during the creation process was the challenge of "information filtering." Distilling complex topics like cyber-safety and professional branding into short, punchy bullet points that fit on a single page required a deep understanding of the subject matter. I initially struggled with the layout, as I wanted to include too much text, but I eventually learned that white space and iconography are more effective for a student audience than dense paragraphs. This exercise taught me that as a Digital Ambassador, my communication must be as visually engaging as it is informative.

Task 2: Building the Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I established a professional digital presence by setting up and updating profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and HackerRank. I chose these specific platforms because they represent the "golden trio" for a B.Tech student: GitHub for version control and project showcasing , LinkedIn for professional networking and career branding , and HackerRank for verifying technical problem-solving skills. On GitHub, I initialized my profile README to introduce myself, my branch, and my learning goals , while on LinkedIn, I focused on detailing my current educational path at VIT Bhopal.

My plan for the next four years is to use these platforms as a "living resume." I intend to commit code to GitHub weekly to document my progress in data structures and web development. On LinkedIn, I plan to connect with industry mentors and alumni to stay informed about internship trends. By maintaining these profiles early on, I am building a searchable, professional trail that will prove my technical consistency and growth to future recruiters long before I even apply for my first full-time role.

Task 3: Coding Practice and Cloud Collaboration

For this task, I focused on bridging the gap between individual technical skills and collaborative digital tools by using HackerRank and Google Workspace. On HackerRank, I practiced fundamental problem-solving by completing the 'Solve Me First' and 'Python Introduction' challenges. These exercises were essential for familiarizing myself with automated evaluation environments and the syntax requirements of competitive coding. Successfully earning my first badge served as a tangible record of my initial technical competency.

In the second part of the task, I transitioned to cloud collaboration by building a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. I designed a five-question assessment that included multiple-choice questions on cyber-safety and short-answer prompts regarding professional branding. I also configured the linked Google Sheet to monitor responses in real-time. These tools are invaluable for my academic journey as they facilitate seamless data collection and teamwork on group projects. Mastering these platforms ensures that I can efficiently manage information and collaborate with peers in a professional, cloud-based environment.

Task 4: Professional Communication and Etiquette

In this task, I applied formal communication standards by drafting two distinct professional emails: one requesting an assignment extension from a professor and another expressing interest in a summer internship. These drafts required a focus on clear subject lines, respectful salutations, and a structured, concise body. To complement these, I developed a "Social Media Do’s and Don’ts" checklist to guide peers in maintaining a responsible digital footprint.

The key learning from this exercise was the importance of "digital intentionality." Analyzing a scenario where a private group chat leak led to disciplinary action highlighted that no digital space is truly private. I learned that poor digital communication can have lasting real-world consequences. Moving forward, I understand that professional success depends as much on clear, respectful correspondence as it does on technical ability, and I will always treat my digital messages as permanent records.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness and Prevention

Researching modern cyber-threats for my Digital Ambassador role revealed a staggering reality: phishing remains the most prevalent cybercrime globally, with nearly 300,000 complaints recorded in a single year. I was most surprised by the psychological sophistication of these scams; attackers no longer rely on obvious technical "hacks" but instead exploit human emotions like fear and urgency to bypass security. Learning about the 1930 Helpline and the critical "Golden Hour" for freezing UPI transactions in India highlighted how vital immediate response is for financial recovery.

As a direct result of this research, I am immediately changing my habit of password reuse. I previously used similar credentials across multiple platforms, which I now recognize as a major security liability. Moving forward, I am adopting a dedicated Password Manager to ensure every account has a unique, complex password and enabling Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) on all academic and financial profiles to build a multi-layered defense.

Conclusion: Overall Learning

Completing this project as a Student Digital Ambassador has fundamentally changed my perspective on what it means to be digitally literate. Beyond just using tools, I have learned that true digital literacy involves the strategic management of one's professional identity on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn. I now understand that professional communication—whether through a structured email or a cautious social media presence—is a critical skill that impacts academic and career success. Most importantly, the research into cyber-threats in India has made me more vigilant regarding financial and personal data security. This portfolio is not just an assignment; it is the foundation of my professional digital footprint for the next four years.

References

- VIT Bhopal University, *CSE0001 - Digital Literacy Project Assignment Brief*.
- Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI), *Internet Crime Complaint Center (IC3) 2023 Report*.
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal, cybercrime.gov.in.
- Digital Tools**:** Canva, GitHub, LinkedIn, HackerRank, and Google Workspace.